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On Being Tired

I am tired.

Every day, at least one of us is tired. And we have our lovely reasons to be as such. For example, when I go to my bed and cover myself up with my blankets and sleep like a log for nine hours straight, I am tired. When I express my frustration towards certain people's actions, I am tired of them. When I walk out of a conversation, I am tired of listening to what's being talked about. When I walk away from my desk and barricade myself in my bedroom after stealing my mother's AirPods to listen to Bayaan, Murtaza Qizilbash, and Abdul Hannan (my favorite band and singers to the end of time), I am tired of work and of working.

I can be tired in numerous ways. I can also be "tired." But what do these states of being tired even mean?

Physically Tired

Keeping our bodies actively turned on is no joke.

It takes considerable energy to wake up, decide we have to start the day, get ready, get to our destinations, and work. By the end of the day, we return as droopy, sluggish entities, dragging ourselves to do more work. And no matter how satisfying or fun this work is, we attain the state of tiredness (or salvation, as one of my dear friends would say). We cannot continue. Slowly, we lose the ability to decide what our bodies do. No matter how determined you are, your body wins.

It's funny. Humans normally do not relinquish control over anything. From the kings of the olden ages to that teenager with eye bags fighting with their bodies to finish a major presentation at 2 AM. And here, we relinquish control over our own bodies. Our internal operators decide they want us to sleep, and we have no choice but to abide.

Mentally Tired

Not everything is external, though: what you see on the outside is not the state of the inside. Such is our tiredness.

While doing our work, we think. Thinking takes stupendous amounts of work. And sometimes, if we do more work than what we set our capacity for, we can get mentally tired.

How many of you all have slept through a major exam, like the SAT or AP? I have, too.

But there are more reasons. Sometimes, your brain requires stimulation to perform tasks. And we find it abnormally challenging to do these tasks simply because we find them repetitive or

uninteresting. So, how will your brain stay engaged with your work? That is also called being mentally tired: when you try to do something or just be, but your inner workings won't let you.

"A bit 'tired,' sorry I wasn't able to do much work"

Ah, these tired people are the most interesting ones! You've hit the crux of the crisis. Now, you've hit the trifecta.

In our growing world, our way of life has evolved to be fast. Instantaneous. Permanently reactive.

These people often know what to do. They know how to do what they need to do. But, they do not have the energy or stamina to do so. These people often appear to have their rockets fully off. And they are the most misunderstood. They do not always have the energy to maintain an appearance. Even if they have the drive, they are the most exhausted. And yet, they do not complain; they simply continue on with life.

Yes, we might not appear to be doing work. We appear to be slumping. We appear to be the ones falling into a deep slumber in the middle of a history lesson. And, at times, we just might.

But this accumulation of tiredness rises up from the need to always be on. To always perform to the greatest extent possible. And this, my dear friend, is unsustainable. It rises from expectations, expectations that fall onto our bodies. Day and night, at home or at school, inside or outside, it clouds around us. It climbs up our spines and attaches itself. Forever. It produces chills. It's cold inside. It's cold outside. It's an invisible cloud hovering every day. I can't escape it. I can't stop it. I am helpless. And I silently implore.

My inner lamp has fizzled out.

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